

8 · Quit India Movement & Independence

SSC CGL Tier I · Modern History · keyword revision notes · Communal Award/Poona Pact → GoI Act 1935 → WWII/Cripps → Quit India & martyrs → INA & RIN Mutiny → Cabinet Mission → Mountbatten & Independence · appendix at end

Last-minute 12

1. **Communal Award (MacDonald Award), 16 Aug 1932** — PM Ramsay MacDonald; separate electorate for Depressed Classes + Muslims/Sikhs/Christians/Europeans; Gandhi opposed (fast unto death), Ambedkar supported → **Poona Pact, 24 Sep 1932**, Yerwada Jail, Pune — joint (not separate) electorate, seats increased 71→148; Malaviya signed for Gandhi
2. **Government of India Act 1935** — provincial autonomy, abolished dyarchy, federal structure (never implemented); royal assent 4 Aug 1935; ★proposed establishment of federal government; Nehru: "a new charter of bondage"
3. **1937 elections** — Congress formed ministries in 7/11 (later 8) provinces, except Punjab(Unionist)/Bengal(KPP+League)/Sindh(United Party); Congress ministries **resigned Dec 1939** over WWII involvement w/o consultation — League's "Day of Deliverance"
4. Congress sessions 1934–39: Congress Socialist Party(1934, JP Narayan/Lohia) · AIKS(1936 Lucknow, Sahajanand Saraswati) · Haripura(1938, Bose president, NPC formed/Nehru chair) · Tripuri(1939, Bose re-elected over Pattabhi Sitaramayya, resigned → Forward Bloc)
5. **August Offer (1940, Linlithgow)** — Dominion Status promised, rejected by Congress (Nehru: "dead as a doornail") & League (Parmar)/welcomed by League (Lucent, DOUBT); **Individual Satyagraha** — Vinoba Bhave 1st, then Nehru/Patel
6. **Cripps Mission (1942)** — Dominion Status after war, province opt-out right; rejected by all; Gandhi: "post-dated cheque on a crumbling/failing bank"
7. ★ **Quit India Movement, 8 Aug 1942** ("August Kranti") — "Do or Die" (Gowalia Tank); leaders arrested Day 1 (leaderless); Aruna Asaf Ali hoisted the flag; underground radio (Usha Mehta); parallel govts (Ballia-Chittu Pandey, Satara-longest); martyrs incl. Kanaklata Barua(Assam) & Matangini Hazra(Tamluk) — PYQ-only, see A.2
8. **Pakistan Movement** — "Pakistan" coined by Rahmat Ali (1933/1935, DOUBT); ★**Lahore/Pakistan Resolution, 22–24 Mar 1940** — separate Muslim homeland demanded
9. **INA** — formed 1942, Mohan Singh → Rash Behari Bose → reorganised by Subhas Bose, Singapore 1943; Rani of Jhansi Regiment (Capt. Lakshmi Swaminathan); flag hoisted Moirang, Manipur, 14 Apr 1944; Bose d. 18 Aug 1945 (air crash); INA Trials, Red Fort, Nov 1945 (Sehgal/Shah Nawaz/Dhillon)
10. **RIN Mutiny, 18 Feb 1946** — HMS Talwar, Bombay → spread Calcutta/Karachi; called off via Congress+League

Key

TRAP easily confused pair

PYQ a real past SSC paper tested this — exact citation given

DOUBT sources conflict / unverified

★ tested in history_pyq.pdf
(exam+date+shift in the appendix) · no personal attempt data exists for this book source, so there are no "my mistake" boxes anywhere in this build

11. **Cabinet Mission (Mar 1946)** — Pethick-Lawrence/Cripps/Alexander; 3-tier structure, Groups A/B/C; rejected separate Pakistan; League's ★ **Direct Action Day, 16 Aug 1946** → Great Calcutta Killing → Noakhali Riots (Gandhi visited)
12. **Mountbatten Plan, 3 June 1947** → Indian Independence Act 1947; 565 princely states, 562 joined, 3 held out (J&K/Hyderabad/Junagadh); Gandhi assassinated by **Nathuram Godse, 30 Jan 1948**, Birla House

1 Communal Award, Poona Pact & Untouchability

Communal Award/MacDonald Award (16 Aug 1932) — PM Ramsay MacDonald; separate electorate for "Depressed Classes" + Muslims, Sikhs, Christians, Europeans (Parmar also adds Marathas). Gandhi strongly opposed it (threat to Hindu unity), fasted unto death; Ambedkar supported it (safeguards representation). Congress itself "neither accepted nor rejected" it.

Poona Pact, 24 Sep 1932, Yerwada Central Jail, Pune — Gandhi & Ambedkar (Malaviya signed on Gandhi's behalf): separate electorate dropped for a **joint electorate**; reserved seats raised from 71 (Award) to **148** in provincial legislatures, 18% at the Centre.

HOOK Gandhi's anti-untouchability efforts: **All India Anti-Untouchability League (1932)** → renamed **Harijan Sevak Sangh**; weekly *Harijan* — cross-ref Ch.2 §4.

2 Government of India Act 1935 & the 1937 Elections

- **Gol Act 1935** — based on the Simon Commission report; royal assent 4 Aug 1935; introduced **provincial autonomy, abolished dyarchy in provinces** (kept it at the Centre, never implemented), ministers responsible to the legislature, federal structure. Condemned by Congress; Nehru: "a new charter of bondage."
- ★ Its major proposal: establishment of a **federal government**.
- **1937 elections**: Congress formed ministries in 7/11 provinces (later 8), except Punjab (Unionist Party), Bengal (Krishak Praja Party+Muslim League coalition), Sindh (United Party). Jinnah: "Congress was drunk with power and was oppressive against Muslims" (Lucent).
- **Congress ministries resigned, Dec 1939** — protesting India's WWII involvement without consultation; demanded a Constituent Assembly + full responsible govt.; Viceroy Linlithgow's reply (17 Oct 1939) rejected this. Muslim League observed **22 Dec 1939** as "**Day of Deliverance**."

HOOK Congress sessions, 1934–39: **1934** Congress Socialist Party (JP Narayan, Ram Manohar Lohia, Minoo Masani) · **1936 Lucknow** All India Kisan Sabha (Swami Sahajanand Saraswati) · **1937 Faizpur** (1st village session; Nehru) · **1938 Haripura** (Bose elected President; National Planning Committee formed, 1st chairman Nehru) · **1939 Tripuri** (Jabalpur; Bose re-elected, defeating Gandhi's candidate Pattabhi Sitaramayya; Bose resigned, formed **All India Forward Bloc (1939, Unnao)**).

3 World War II, August Offer & the Cripps Mission

WWII (1939): Allied Powers (Britain/France/USA/USSR) vs Axis (Germany/Italy/Japan). INC's Oct 1939 demands to Viceroy Linlithgow: Constituent Assembly + responsible govt. at Centre & provinces.

August Offer (1940, Linlithgow, under Churchill's direction per Parmar): Dominion Status promised; Indian-majority Constituent Assembly; advisory war council; minority veto on future constitution. **DOUBT** Congress rejected it (Nehru: "dead as a doornail"); Parmar says the **Muslim League also rejected** it, while Lucent

Individual Satyagraha (1940): Gandhi's response to the Offer's failure; Vinoba Bhave 1st Satyagrahi, Nehru 2nd, Brahma Dutt 3rd (Parmar)/Patel among later ones (Lucent). Revolutionary Socialist Party founded 1940.

says the League **welcomed** it (hoping grouping led to Pakistan) — a direct cross-book conflict, not reconciled.

HOOK Cripps Mission (Mar-Apr 1942) — background: Japanese advance to Burma, Pearl Harbor pressure (Roosevelt), Operation Barbarossa. Proposals: Constituent Assembly, Dominion Status, province opt-out right, minority safeguards. Rejected by all; Gandhi: "a post-dated cheque drawn on a failing/crumbling bank."

4 Quit India Movement (1942)

CWC met at **Wardha (July 1942)**, adopted the Quit India Resolution, ratified at **Gowalia Tank, Bombay**. Launched by Gandhi **8 Aug 1942** ("August Kranti"), after Cripps Mission's failure. "**Do or Die**" slogan at Gowalia Tank Maidan. All leaders arrested Day 1 (a "leaderless movement"); ★ **Aruna Asaf Ali** presided over the CWC and hoisted the flag at Gowalia Tank ("Grand Old Lady" of the freedom struggle).

Gandhi's appeals: govt. servants — don't resign, work subtly against British policy; soldiers — don't resign, but refuse to fire on compatriots; peasants — withhold rent from pro-British landlords; princely-state subjects — support anti-British rulers, peacefully oppose pro-British ones.

Martyrs (raw extraction): Kushal Konwar — only Quit-India-phase martyr who was *hanged*. ★ Two further martyrs are PYQ-book-only (not in either source book, see A.2): **Kanaklata Barua** ("Birbala," Assam) shot hoisting the tricolour; posthumous title "Rani"/"Daughter of the Hills" from Nehru, Tamrapatra(1972) & Padma Bhushan(1982); and **Matangini Hazra** (Tamluk, Bengal), shot leading a procession 29 Sep 1942, martyred chanting "Vande Mataram."

HOOK Underground activities: Usha Mehta's underground radio, Bombay. **Parallel governments:** Ballia, UP (Chittu Pandey, first) · Tamluk, Bengal (Jatiya Sarkar/Satis Samant) · Satara, Maharashtra (Y.B. Chavhan & Nana Patil — longest-lived) · Talchar, Odisha.

5 Pakistan Movement & Mediation Attempts

- "Pakistan" coined by **Rahmat Ali** (1933, Parmar / 1935, Lucent — DOUBT), building on Iqbal's 1930 idea.
- ★ **Lahore/Pakistan Resolution, 22-24 March 1940** — Muslim League's Lahore session; demanded a separate Muslim homeland in NW+E India, rejecting the GoI Act 1935 federal scheme. **Pakistan Day** observed 23 March 1943.
- **C.R. Formula (1944)** — Rajagopalachari's plebiscite proposal for Muslim-majority NW/East districts; Jinnah objected (wanted only League-approved Muslims voting); Savarkar condemned it.
- **Desai-Liaquat Pact (1945)** — unsuccessful, Bhulabhai Desai (Congress) & Liaquat Ali Khan (League).
- **Wavell Plan & Shimla Conference (14 June-14 July 1945)** — Viceroy Wavell's balanced-representation Executive Council proposal; failed on Jinnah's insistence that only League-picked Muslims join.

6 INA, Subhas Chandra Bose & the RIN Mutiny

Indian National Army: formed 1942, Mohan Singh (with POWs, Singapore) → handed to Rash Behari Bose → reorganised by **Subhas Chandra Bose, Singapore, 1943**; Provisional Government of Free India, Singapore, 21 Oct 1943. 3 brigades (Subhas/Gandhi/Nehru) + **Rani of Jhansi Regiment** (women, Capt. Lakshmi Swaminathan). **14 Apr 1944:** Col. Shaukat Ali Malik hoisted the tricolour at **Moirang, Manipur** — first on Indian soil by the INA.

HOOK INA Trials, Red Fort, Nov 1945-May 1946 — 1st trial: P.K. Sehgal, Shah Nawaz Khan, Gurbaksh Singh Dhillon; defence incl. Bhulabhai Desai (chief), Nehru, Sapru, Asaf Ali. **RIN/Ratings Mutiny, 18 Feb 1946** — HMS Talwar, Bombay, over poor pay/food; spread to Calcutta & Karachi; called off via Congress+League persuasion (Patel & Jinnah, per Lucent).

Bose: b. Cuttack, 23 Jan 1897 (birthday = Parakram Divas); met Hitler as "Orlando Mazzotta" (1942); founded Free India/Tiger Legion, Berlin (1941); slogans "Delhi Chalo," "Jai Hind," "Give me blood, and I shall give you freedom"; d. **18 Aug 1945**, air crash; called "Patriot of Patriots" by Gandhi; gave Gandhi the title "Father of the Nation" (1944, Singapore Radio).

7 Cabinet Mission, Direct Action Day & Mountbatten Plan

- **Cabinet Mission (March 1946)** — PM Attlee's delegation: Lord Pethick-Lawrence (Chair), Stafford Cripps, A.V. Alexander. Rejected a separate Pakistan; proposed 3-tier structure — Federal Union / provincial Groups / provinces. **Group A** (Hindu-majority: Madras/Bombay/UP/Bihar/Odisha/CP), **Group B** (Muslim-majority: Punjab/NWFP/Sindh/Baluchistan), **Group C** (Bengal+Assam). Constituent Assembly + interim government proposed. **Attlee's Declaration, 20 Feb 1947:** power transferred by 30 June 1948.
- **Response:** Congress accepted partially (opposed compulsory grouping); League initially accepted, then Jinnah called ★ **Direct Action Day, 16 Aug 1946** — triggered the "**Great Calcutta Killing.**" **Noakhali Riots (Oct-Nov 1946)** followed; Gandhi visited to restore peace.
- **Mountbatten Plan, 3 June 1947** ("Partition Plan") — basis for the Indian Independence Act; princely states could join India, Pakistan, or (initially) stay independent. Of 565 states, **562 joined**; 3 held out — **J&K, Hyderabad, Junagadh**. Mountbatten: last Viceroy + 1st Governor-General of independent India (1947–48); **C. Rajagopalachari: only Indian Governor-General** (post later abolished).

8 After Independence

- **Operation Polo (Sep 1948)** — Hyderabad Police Action, Maj. Gen. J.N. Chaudhuri; Nizam Mir Osman Ali Khan surrendered 17 Sep 1948.
- Maharaja Hari Singh signed the **Instrument of Accession, 26 Oct 1947** (J&K).
- **Gandhi's assassination: 30 Jan 1948**, Birla House, Delhi — shot by **Nathuram Godse** (3 bullets) during evening prayer; reason: blamed Gandhi's non-violence/Muslim-appeasement for Partition. Godse & accomplice Narayan Apte hanged, Ambala Jail, 15 Nov 1949. V.D. Savarkar (Hindu Mahasabha) was Godse's acknowledged political guru, though not formally an RSS leader.

A Appendix

A.1 PYQ citations — every ★ fact in this chapter

Fact tested	Exam citation	Answer
Major reform proposed by the Government of India Act 1935	SSC PHASE XIII, 31/07/2025 (Shift-01)	Establishment of federal government
What the "Lahore Resolution" (1940) demanded	SSC CPO TIER-I, 12/12/2025 (Shift-02)	Separate Muslim state in NW & E India
Key provision of the Indian Independence Act 1947 re: princely states	SSC CPO TIER-I, 11/12/2025 (Shift-01)	Freedom to join India, Pakistan, or remain independent
Consequences of the Partition under the Indian Independence Act	SSC CPO TIER-I, 10/12/2025 (Shift-02)	Widespread violence, displacement, long-lasting tensions
Leader remembered for hoisting the flag at Gowalia Tank Maidan, 1942	SSC CGL TIER-I, 25/09/2025 (Shift-02)	Aruna Asaf Ali
Role of Aruna Asaf Ali in Indian history	SSC CGL TIER-I, 25/09/2025 (Shift-01)	Hoisted the Indian flag during the Quit India Movement
Why Matangini Hazra is remembered	SSC CGL TIER-I, 26/09/2025 (Shift-01)	Bravery in the freedom struggle

Fact tested	Exam citation	Answer
State where Kanaklata Barua was shot hoisting the flag, Quit India Movement	SSC CGL TIER-I, 21/09/2025 (Shift-02)	Assam
Baji Raut's age at martyrdom (refused to ferry British police, Dhenkanal)	SSC CGL TIER-I, 21/09/2025 (Shift-02)	12 years

A.2 New facts sourced only from the PYQ book (not in Parmar or Lucent)

- **Kanaklata Barua** ("Birbala," Assam) — shot dead hoisting the national flag during Quit India; entirely absent from the raw extraction, which names only Kushal Konwar and Kanaklata Barua (the latter appearing only in Ch.9's PYQ, not the books) as Quit-India martyrs.
- **Matangini Hazra** (Tamluk, Bengal) — led a procession 29 Sep 1942, shot, martyred chanting "Vande Mataram"; not named in either source book (the raw extraction names only the Tamluk parallel-government leaders, not Hazra herself).
- **Baji Raut** (Dhenkanal, Odisha, b. 5 Oct 1926) — refused to ferry British police across the Brahmani river during the 1938 Prajamandal (princely-state peoples') movement; martyred aged 12, "youngest martyr of India." Chronologically pre-dates Quit India and belongs more properly to the princely-states/Miscellaneous bucket, but grouped here since the PYQ book files it alongside the other Quit-India-era youth martyrs.

A.3 Cross-book & cross-source doubts carried forward

- **Muslim League's response to the August Offer:** Parmar says the League *also rejected* it; Lucent says the League *welcomed* it. A direct, unreconciled contradiction.
- **"Pakistan" coinage year:** 1933 (Parmar) vs 1935 (Lucent).
- **Gandhi's location on 15 Aug 1947:** Parmar says Noakhali; Lucent's chronology says Calcutta.
- **Congress ministries' resignation month:** Parmar says "October 1939"; Lucent and the Muslim League's own "Day of Deliverance" both point to 22 December 1939 as the actual resignation date.
- **INA trial defence lawyers:** Parmar lists Kailash Nath Katju; Lucent lists Muhammad Ali Jinnah instead, among otherwise-overlapping names.
- **"Rani Lakshmibai Regiment" (Parmar) vs "Rani of Jhansi Brigade" (Lucent)** — same unit, different naming; used interchangeably in §6.

A.4 Completeness check

Every fact in Parmar's ch.8 raw extraction and the corresponding second half of Lucent's continuous Gandhian-Era narrative (Communal Award through Independence, per the raw file's own Part B index) is represented above, except: the WWII "Little Boy/Fat Man" promotional aside (author's own book-naming joke, not history content) and the current-affairs 1971/2025 box on the Bangladesh Liberation War and Indus Waters Treaty suspension, which the raw extraction itself flags as unverified and outside Modern-History-freedom-struggle scope. French/Portuguese colonial integration (1954/1961, Lucent-only) is noted in passing but not built out, since no PYQ in this build tests it.